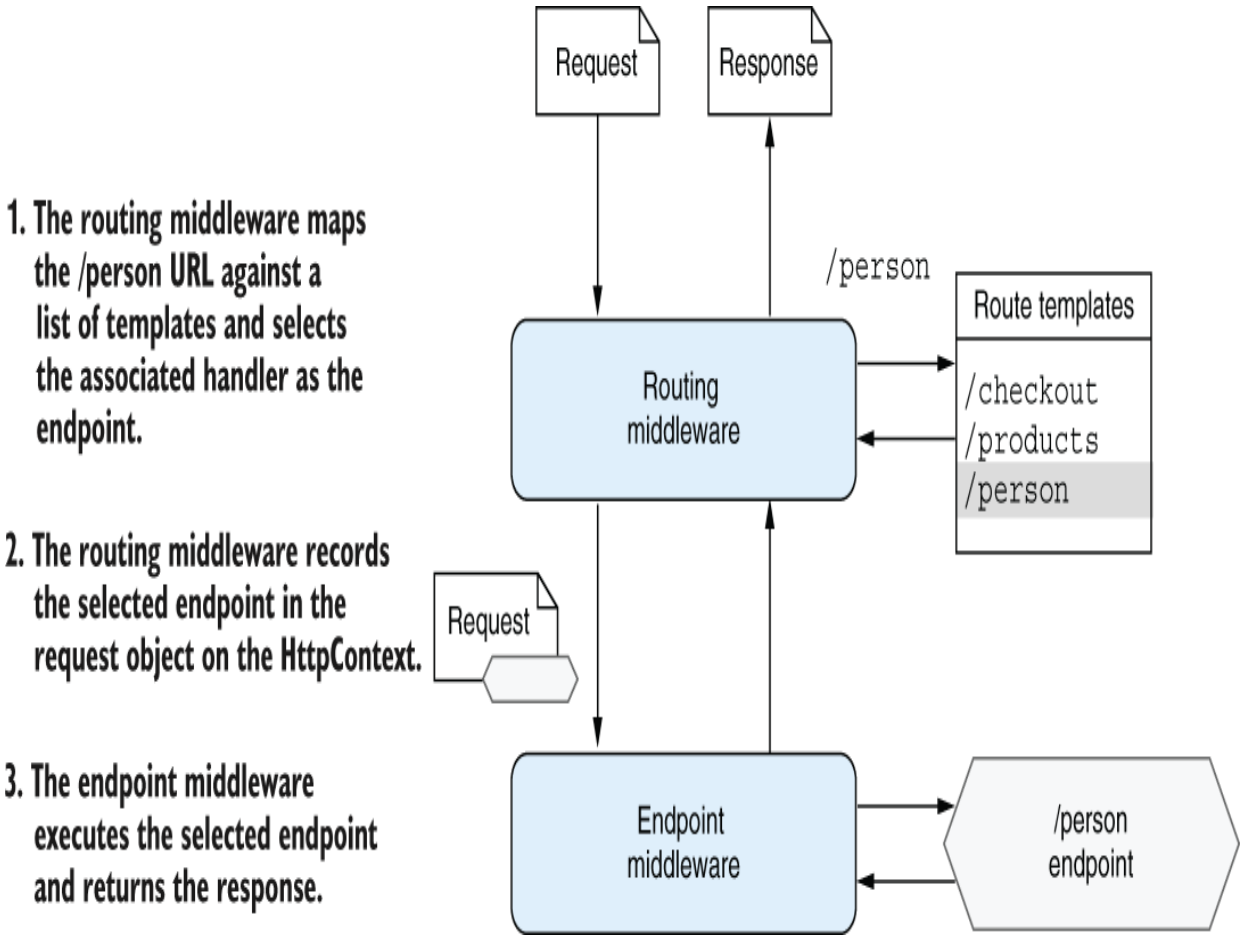


Figure 6.1 The router compares the request URL with a list of configured route templates to determine which handler to execute.

On the face of it, that seems pretty simple. You may wonder why I need a whole chapter to explain that obvious mapping. The simplicity of the mapping in this case belies how powerful routing can be. If this approach, using a direct comparison with static strings, were the only one available, you'd be severely limited in the applications you could feasibly build.

Consider an e-commerce application that sells multiple products. Each product needs to have its own URL, so if you were using a purely static routing system, you'd have only two options: